Federal Risk and Authorization Management Program
General Services Administration
1800 F Street, NW, Washington, DC 20405
info@fedramp.gov | www.fedramp.gov

TO: Meridian Knowledge Solutions

DATE: March 06, 2026

FedRAMP has determined that Meridian LMS meets the initial requirements for a limited FedRAMP authorization as part of the 20x Phase Two pilot! Congratulations and thank you for participating in this pilot.

Meridian LMS will be listed on the FedRAMP Marketplace as 20x Moderate Authorized with an additional note that this is a limited pilot authorization. **This limited pilot authorization will expire on March 07, 2027**, but may be revoked earlier by FedRAMP if 20x ongoing authorization requirements are not met.

Ongoing Authorization Requirements

To maintain this limited pilot authorization Meridian Knowledge Solutions MUST demonstrate continuous progress towards adoption of 20x requirements with Moderate applicability for Meridian LMS. Current requirements can be found on https://www.fedramp.gov/docs/ and will require rework and improvements over time.

FedRAMP will work with Meridian Knowledge Solutions to review progress with Meridian Knowledge Solutions at least quarterly.

Obtaining Full Authorization

Meridian LMS will be granted full FedRAMP 20x Moderate Authorization once Meridian Knowledge Solutions demonstrates all requirements at the 20x Moderate applicability within the FedRAMP Consolidated Ruleset 2026 (CR26) have been met. The CR26 has not been published at this time due to the nature of the pilot process.

Pete Waterman / FedRAMP Director

FedRAMP Validation Report

Approach

As part of the FedRAMP 20x Phase 2 pilot, Fortreum, LLC (Fortreum) performed an independent verification of Meridian Knowledge Solution's Meridian LMS service offering. As the designated accredited FedRAMP Third Party Assessment Organization (3PAO), Fortreum employed a structured and collaborative methodology designed to support the accelerated objectives of the 20x initiative. As part of this process, Fortreum reviewed the evidence supplied for each 20x Key Security Indicator (KSI) and determined whether it met the applicable requirements.

FedRAMP Senior Cloud Security Engineers under the supervision of the FedRAMP Security Director conducted interviews with Meridian staff and the Fortreum auditor. The FedRAMP team reviewed the current implementation of security and engineering solutions supporting each 20x KSI and discussed Meridian's approach to the KSI and plans for future improvements.

Scope

The assessment scope is contained to the Meridian LMS Software as a Service (SaaS) offering (FR ID: FR2527956755) which is running on the AWS Commercial (FR ID: AGENCYAMAZONEW) platform within the AWS East region and associated third party services including but not limited to Okta IDaaS Regulated Cloud (F1512167750). This scope does NOT include any client side components or the Meridian LMS self-hosted deployment option.

Summary

The FedRAMP review team and Fortreum had access to both the Meridian Trust Center and their private GitHub Repository and leveraged this information during assessment and validation. The Trust Center has both Public and Private elements with a simple agency signup and approval process. The Meridian team has participated in FedRAMP 20x from early inception and has historical data on Key Security Indicator (KSI) status starting from June 2025.

Meridian LMS mostly leverages native AWS services and is contained to a single VPC with a small number of EC2 and RDS instances and S3 buckets. Most of the automation is based on AWS CLI queries processed by their python backend which performs the validation logic.

Information displayed on the trust center web interface is derived from the machine-readable file provided in the package download, so there is a high degree of confidence that the KSI information between human and machine-readable information reconciles.

Fortreum has attested to quantitative automated validation review and expert qualitative assessment of the effectiveness, completeness, and integrity of the automated validations.

Process Name	Overall	Implemented	Intent	Coverage	Readability	Confidence	Automation	Historical Data	Persistent Validation		Identified Risks
Minimum Assessment Scope	■	■	▲	▼	■	▼	▼	▲	▼		
Authorization Data Sharing	▲	▲	▲	▼	▲	▼	▲	▼	▲		Machine-readable KSI schema not accessible via Trust Center Unclear how certain historical package data is made available
Using Cryptographic Modules	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■		
Vulnerability Detection and Response	▲	■	▲	■	■	▼	▲	▲	▲		json output vs trust center dashboard is out of sync
Significant Change Notifications	■	■	■	▼	▲	■	■		▼		
Persistent Validation and Assessment	▼	■	■	▼	▼	▼	■		■		3PAO report not accessible via Trust Center
Secure Configuration Guide	■	■	▼	■	▼	▲	▲		▼		
Continuous Collaborative Monitoring	■	■	■	▼	▲	■	■		▼		
FedRAMP Security Inbox	▼	■	▼	▼	▼	▼	▼		▼		
Incident Communication Procedures	■	■	■	▼	■	■	▼	▼	▼		
Key Security Indicator Theme											
Change Management	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	▲	▲		No direct access to referenced policies
Cloud-Native Architecture	▲	■	■	■	■	▼	■	▲	▲		Confusion or possible inconsistencies between output results and validation logic
Cybersecurity Education	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	▲	▲		
Identity and Access Management	▲	■	■	■	■	▼	■	▲	▲		Confusion or possible inconsistencies between output results and validation logic
Incident Response	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	▲	▲		
Monitoring, Logging, and Auditing	▲	■	■	■	■	▼	■	▲	▲		Confusion or possible inconsistencies between output results and validation logic
Policy and Inventory	▲	■	■	■	■	▼	■	▲	▲		Confusion or possible inconsistencies between output results and validation logic
Recovery Planning	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	▲	▲		
Service Configuration	▲	■	■	■	■	▼	■	▲	▲		Confusion or possible inconsistencies between output results and validation logic
Supply Chain Risk	▲	■	■	■	■	■	■	▲	▲		Doesn't include non-AWS services like Okta

KEY	▲	Exceeds	■	Meets	▼	Below

FedRAMP Validation Scorecard v1A

This FedRAMP Validation Scorecard is experimental and subject to change.

The scoring will continue to be updated as FedRAMP meets with providers to review updates during the pilot authorization period.

Overall scoring:
>14 : ▲ (above)
12-14 : ■ (meets)
<12 : ▼ (below)

Individual scoring:
3 : ▲ (above)
2 : ■ (meets)
1 : ▼ (below)
0 : not present

Implemented - exists as generally expected

Intent - meets the "spirit" of what is described

Coverage - all FRRs/KSIs documented

Readability - simple to find and understand information

Confidence - trust in the validation

Automation - *self explanatory*

Historical Data - past to current info accessible

Persistent Validation - KSI is continuously validated

Actions Required

Due: 2 weeks

- Update Trust Center to include:
  - 3PAO report
  - Machine-readable schema
  - Authorization letter

Due: Prior to next quarterly review

- Address missing FRR requirements and recommendations

Review Team Feedback

General

Overall the Meridian Trust Center was simple for the review team to navigate and download the package. The few issues or feedback provided were fixed very quickly. There is a wealth of historical information dating to June of 2025 and the review team thought the display of the Assessment Scope section was particularly novel. Special attention should be paid to the Transparency Console and Failure screen as this exceeds FedRAMP requirements.

Many of the items highlighted by the review team in the Collaborative Review meeting already have fixes staged in the next version release which the Meridian team is waiting for final disposition from FedRAMP to merge in changes.

- 3PAO report on GitHub repo but not Trust Center
- Machine-readable schema on GitHub repo but not Trust Center
- Effectiveness measurements KSIs not included (CED, INR, etc)
- Challenging to understand logic behind automated validations between cli commands, included outputs and brief trust center descriptions with some possible inconsistencies (CNA, IAM, MLA, PIY, SVC)
- UI Feedback:
  - Bell icon on upper right of trust center had a red alert, but not action on click
  - Assessment scope is a bit cut off at the top

Key Security Indicator (KSI) Specific

- KSI-CED-04 ( ) - "Validation narrative not yet documented for this KSI."
- KSI-CMT-* - We did not have access to view referenced policies
- KSI-MLA-02 - Missing json output for alerting command
- KSI-MLA-07 - Only saw 2 out of 3 json outputs
- KSI-PIY-03 - trust.meridianks.com/security.txt leads nowhere
- KSI-RPL-04 - "Validation narrative not yet documented for this KSI."

- KSI-TPR-04 - Lacks full coverage for other CSOs leveraged (Okta for example)

Minimum Assessment Scope (MAS)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- Labeling of non-FedRAMP Authorized as High risk is confusing from a data categorization perspective, recommend reviewing NIST Special Publication 800-60 Volume II
- Only machine-based resources included
- Didn't see details on automation queries or logic

Authorization Data Sharing (ADS)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- It is unclear if and how historical package data will be made available to customers (please refer to FRR-ADS-09, FRR-CCM-01, and FRR-ICP-05)

Using Cryptographic Modules (UCM)

- No feedback

Vulnerability Detection and Response (VDR)

- Initially could not fully review FRRs, but during Collaborative Review was shown a private dashboard on GitHub repo that is not available on the Trust Center for responsible disclosure reasons.
- Discrepancy between vulnerabilities provided in the machine-readable file versus what is displayed on the dashboard.
- FRR-VDR-01 - Additional vulnerability sources should be included beyond scanners, like audits, incidents or pentests.

Significant Change Notifications (SCN)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- Sample report provided, but real change has not yet been processed

Persistent Validation and Assessment (PVA)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)

Secure Configuration Guide (SCG)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- Automatically generated information in markdown table is challenging to read

Continuous Collaborative Monitoring (CCM)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- Sample OAR and QAR provided, but meeting has not yet been held

FedRAMP Security Inbox (FSI)

- AFR is testing AWS topics > email with no accounting of FedRAMP email > Meridian inbox
- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)

Incident Communication Procedures (ICP)

- Incomplete FRR requirement(s) and recommendation(s)
- Performed incident test with FedRAMP, though information was sent to 20x@fedramp.gov instead of listed security email fedramp_security@fedramp.gov
- Unclear what is in place or planned to make incident report information available to agency customers. If an incident happened on one day, but a customer gets access and signs-up for alerts the next day, how do they get that prior information if they were to need it?
- Unclear if "Response" is being addressed in final incident reports.
- Unclear if the Incident Report will be available in machine readable format.